

Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Student get a glimpse of the world beyond English with a poetic biography and then focus on stories and myths created and collected in the 19th century, including Russian fairy tales, short stories from a variety of authors, and Dickens' famous text, A Christmas Carol.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Several readings are shared with Grades 5-6, though lesson plans include more advanced work for older students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist A Christmas Carol The Man Who Invented Christmas directed Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 7-8				
General Lit: Grades 7-8				Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



A Christmas Carol



The Man Who Invented Christmas directed

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell you about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873), who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. p.169-174 "Historical Note"
2. p.ix "Historical Background"
3. p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week, as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: What Are Free Verse Poems

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has his death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Why does Tula feel she is not so different from the slave girls she views from the barred window?
- Continue to add to your character list.

• COMPOSITION

What role do books and reading have in the story so far? How are the "rules" different for Tula? Caridad? The nuns?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: José María Heredia biography

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

How would you describe this book (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-35

- How do the decisions Tula's mother made differ from what she expects from Tula? What is your impression of her mother so far?
- Why does Tula feel she can free herself "only with words"?
- Why is Tula not allowed to read books? What are her mother and stepfather afraid of happening if she reads books?

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What did we learn about Tula's situation in the last chapter? What does her future hold?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-55

- What have we learned about Caridad and why she might not want to share stories of her childhood?
- What need does the orphan theater fill for Tula? Why does she have to change the stories her plays tell?

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the orphan theater?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-70

- What was Manuel's concern in this chapter? Is it for Tula? Or himself?
- How does reading about injustice differ from actually experiencing it for Tula?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What injustice does Tula experience in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-90

- Has your impression of Tula's mother changed at all throughout the story?
- Do Manuel's actions change your perception of him? How has he supported Tula throughout the story?

• COMPOSITION

Compare the concerns of Tula, Manuel, Caridad, Mama, and the Nuns in pages 73-83. Are they justified or not given the time and setting?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The tertulias brought people together in quiet defiance. They were often political rebellion disguised as parties; a way of sharing counterculture ideas in places where fascist regimes had made it dangerous, even illegal, to gather.

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What risks were Tula and Manuel taking in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-109

- How does Tula learn to hide her messages?
- What are some of the acts of defiance and courage in the book so far, and what are their consequences?
- Why does Mama imagine their lives will be peaceful and prosperous once Tula is married? Do you think she's right?

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Term 1

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-127

- Why can't Tula write even though she now has a degree of freedom with her uncle gone?
- Why does Tula leave the plantation even though she's now left alone there?

WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What was plantation life like for Tula with her uncle gone?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-144

- What happens when some of Tula's fantasies about love meet reality?
- What things do Sab and Tula have in common despite their differences? What insights does Sab's godmother give them?

• COMPOSITION

Explore how Sab and Tula are reflections of each other's freedom dreams. How are their dreams alike? Different?

WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember of Sab's story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.145-159

- Why do you think Tula finally reads her verses in public?
- What do you think will happen after Manuel tells Tula what Mama has planned?

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What happened when Tula went to the city to live?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.160-167 & p.175-179

- We are told why Tula is fleeing to Spain. Why do you think Manuel is joining her? Does this contradict Tula's thoughts that men are freer than women?
- What has Tula learned about love during the book?

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Term 1

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Lightning Dreamer

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ INTRO

A Christmas Carol is a novella, which is longer than a short story but shorter than a novel. It was published on December 19, and the first edition sold out by Christmas Eve, making it an immediate success. Like much of Dickens' writing, the story is a commentary on the social problems of his era, such as poverty, child welfare, and poor working conditions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 Beginning to "closed it with a bang"

- Why do you think Scrooge dislikes Christmas so much?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to. Feel free to move reading this book closer to Christmas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1843 AD: A Christmas Carol published

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Life In A Victorian Workhouse

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

How would you describe Scrooge so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-21 "The sound resounded" - "upon the instant." (end of stave one)

- Why does Scrooge try so hard to explain away Marley's ghost?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Article Link:** How A Christmas Carol Became A Holiday Classic

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 Beginning of Stave two - "upon a winter's night."

- What was Christmas like when Scrooge was young?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Article Link:** 10 Things To Know about Charles Dickens' Christmas Carol

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What mood was Scrooge in when we left off? Notice how his mood changes through stave two.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-39 "In came a fiddler" - end of Stave two

- Why were the scenes with Belle so painful for Scrooge?

• COMPOSITION

Compare Scrooge and Fezziwig as employers. What do the actions of each show about leadership and responsibility for your employees?

∞ **Video Link:** Why Read Charles Dickens?

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did the Ghost of Christmas Past show Scrooge?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Charles Dickens' Home Tour

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.40-51 Stave three - "blushed to hint at such a thing."	
WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP What did Scrooge learn by visiting the Cratchit family? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.51-64 "At last the dinner" - end of Stave three • What do you think the children Ignorance and Want represent?	• COMPOSITION The Ghost of Christmas Present shows Scrooge two suffering children named Ignorance and Want. What do these children represent, and why do you think Dickens showed them in such a shocking way? ∞ Video Link: Dickens' London
WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP Which ghosts have visited Scrooge so far? Who do you think will visit next? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.65-76 Stave four - "there is your father at the door."	• EXTRA HELPING ∞ Video Link: The Story of A Christmas Carol and Victorian England
WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP What do you think will happen next? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.76-89 "She hurried out" - end of stave five. → VIEW (OPTIONAL) ∞ Video Link: How A Christmas Carol Perfectly Demonstrates 5-Act Structure (Note that this is the same structure as many of Shakespeare's plays.)	★ TEACHER NOTE We will spend the next 3-4 lessons watching the movie "The Man Who Invented Christmas." Please preview for your students as needed.
WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21 → INTRO The next few weeks are open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League. ∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland ∞ Link: The Speckled Band ∞ Link: The Redheaded League → VIEW ∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas (Watch over the next 3-4 lessons.)	
WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22 → INTRO Today is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or	

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

→ INTRO

Today is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: A Christmas Carol

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers, who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include "The Adventures of Tom Sawyer" and "Adventures of Huckleberry Finn." Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

The second week of this course, we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

"The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The



Term 3

influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so far?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50.)

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new position" - "place of deposit."

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold-Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?



Term 3

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

"The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for his lengthy novels like *War and Peace* and *Anna Karenina*. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?

WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

"The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band!" Why do you think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?
- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations, and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

• COMPOSITION

Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson, loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold-Bug" (written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- The Lightning Dreamer: Tula defies nearly every expectation placed on her. What does the novel suggest it truly costs to live an authentic life, and is that cost worth it?
- The Lightning Dreamer: Tula believes that poetry can change the world. By the end of the novel, do you think she has been proven right? Use moments from the story to support your position.

Term 2

- A Christmas Carol: Explain how Scrooge changes from the beginning to the end of A Christmas Carol. What helps him change the most? Use examples from the story.

Term 3

- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Choose one story from this term that ends with a "twist" and explain how its ending works. What does it reveal? Why is it effective? What do you think the author most wanted you to take away?
- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Poe's Legrand and Doyle's Sherlock Holmes both solve mysteries through observation and logic, but they are very different kinds of characters. Compare and contrast the two. Which one did you find more compelling and why?